

US Laws and Regulations Cheat Sheet

Estimated time needed: 5 minutes

After completing this reading, you'll be able to:

- Recognize prominent cybersecurity laws globally and their origins.

Introduction

Understanding US cybersecurity laws and regulations is essential for organizations to ensure compliance and protect sensitive information. This cheat sheet provides an overview of key legislations governing data protection and cybersecurity practices.

Law	Description
Computer Fraud and Abuse Act (CFAA) (1986)	A law that combats hacking by making it illegal to access computers without authorization.
Electronic Communications Privacy Act (ECPA) (1986)	Electronic Communications Privacy Act (ECPA) (1986) Protects wire, oral, and electronic communications while they are being made, in transit, and when stored.
Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA) (1998)	Imposes requirements on operators of websites or online services directed to children under 13 years of age.
Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act (GLBA) (1999)	Financial institutions must explain their information-sharing practices to their customers and safeguard sensitive data.
Homeland Security Act (2002), including the Cybersecurity Information Sharing Act (CISA) provisions (2015)	Established the Department of Homeland Security and included measures for cybersecurity information sharing.
Federal Information Security Management Act (FISMA) (2002)	Federal agencies must develop, document, and implement an information security and protection program.
Identity Theft and Assumption Deterrence Act (1998)	It makes identity theft a federal crime, allowing extensive protection for personal identity information.
Cybersecurity Enhancement Act (2014)	It aims to improve cybersecurity measures through increased research and workforce development.
USA FREEDOM Act (2015)	Modified surveillance laws, including limiting the government's bulk collection of telephone metadata.
Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) (1996)	Protects the privacy and security of certain health information.
Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) (1974)	Protects the privacy of student education records.
Sarbanes-Oxley Act (SOX) (2002)	Protects investors from fraudulent financial reporting by corporations.

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